AKLAB.LOCAL

IT SUPPORT RESOLVED TICKETS KNOWLEDGE BASE

Active Directory • Help Desk • Windows Administration

Purpose

The purpose of this ticket knowledge base is to be a practical, topic-based reference for diagnosing, configuring, and verifying common Active Directory, Windows, and IT help desk operations.

Scope and applicability

These articles provide reusable guidance for common Active Directory, Windows administration, and IT support tasks in the AKLab environment.

Note: Please check prerequisites and adapt the procedures to the current system configuration before making changes.

How to use this knowledge base

1. Start from the Contents page and select the article matching the issue.
2. Read the scope and possible causes before making changes.
3. Follow the diagnostic sequence and confirm the issue before changing configuration.
4. Use least privilege and obtain authorization for account, permission, or security changes.
5. Complete the verification checks and confirm the expected outcome.
6. Use the article ID to find related guidance when needed.

Article conventions

The article IDs correspond to AKLAB help desk scenarios. Use the procedures as reference guidance, verify the outcomes, and avoid exposing passwords or sensitive information.

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HD-001 | Password Reset Request

Category: Account & Identity Management

Purpose

The ticket register identifies a password-reset request. Use this guide when a domain user cannot authenticate because their password is forgotten or needs to be changed.

When to use this guide

Password reset

Recommended procedure

1. Confirm the requester's identity using the organization's approved process.

2. Locate the correct user account in Active Directory Users and Computers (ADUC).

3. Reset the password only after authorization; communicate the temporary password through an approved secure channel and require a change at next logon where appropriate.

Verification

Verify that the user can sign in and that the account is not locked or disabled.

Note: Never include a real password in a ticket, screenshot, or knowledge article.

HD-008 | Requesting Temporary Account Lockdown

Category: Account & Identity Management

Purpose

A request is made to temporarily restrict an account.

When to use this guide

Temporary account restriction

Recommended procedure

Confirm the scope, reason, authorization, and duration. Determine whether disabling the account, restricting sign-in, or another approved control is appropriate. Record who authorized the action and the planned restoration point.

Verification

1. Verify the intended restriction is active.

2. Record the re-enable condition and ensure the account is restored only after authorization.

HD-012 | Enabling Disabled Account

Category: Account & Identity Management

Purpose

An authorized request is made to re-enable a disabled account.

When to use this guide

Re-enable user account

Recommended procedure

1. Confirm the account owner, reason for the previous disablement, approval to restore access, and whether the user is still employed or entitled to access.

2. Locate the exact AD account and enable it only after validation.

Verification

Verify the account is enabled and confirm the user can authenticate. Check group membership and access remain appropriate; enabling an account should not automatically restore unnecessary privileges.

HD-014 | Consecutive Failed Authentication Attempts

Category: Account & Identity Management

Purpose

Repeated authentication failures may trigger account lockout or indicate stale credentials.

When to use this guide

Repeated failed sign-ins

Recommended procedure

Identify the account and time pattern. Check whether the user is entering an incorrect password or whether saved credentials, mapped drives, services, scheduled tasks, or other devices are retrying old credentials. Review relevant security events where available.

Verification

1. After correcting the source, verify successful sign-in and monitor for repeated failures.

2. Unlocking the account alone may not resolve the underlying cause.

HD-002 | Cannot Access Employees Shared Folder

Category: File Shares & Permissions

Purpose

A user reports that the Employees shared folder cannot be opened.

When to use this guide

Shared-folder access

Recommended procedure

1. Confirm the user, computer, share path, and exact error.

2. Test name resolution and network reachability to the file server.

3. Review both share permissions and NTFS permissions, then inspect the user's effective access through group membership and inheritance.

4. Apply only the minimum approved permission change.

Verification

Retest using the affected user account. Confirm authorized access works and that unrelated folders remain restricted. Do not grant broad access such as everyone, full control as a workaround.

HD-005 | Unable to Access CompanyShare Network Location

Category: File Shares & Permissions

Purpose

A workstation cannot reach the CompanyShare network location.

When to use this guide

Network share connectivity

Recommended procedure

1. Confirm the UNC path, for example, \\DC01\CompanyShare, and verify the client has the expected IP configuration and DNS server.

2. Test server name resolution and connectivity.

3. Check that the share exists and that the Server service and firewall configuration permit SMB access.

Verification

Open the UNC path from the client using the affected account. Distinguish a network/path problem from an authorization problem; do not change permissions unless evidence points to an access-control issue.

HD-015 | Unable to Access the Marketing Folder

Category: File Shares & Permissions

Purpose

A Marketing user cannot access the Marketing shared folder.

When to use this guide

Department folder access

Recommended procedure

1. Confirm the intended Marketing access group and the folder's share and NTFS permissions.

2. Check whether the user is a member of the correct security group and whether group membership has refreshed in the current logon session.

Verification

Sign out and back in if group-token refresh is required, then retest. Confirm access is limited to the intended department resources.

HD-003 | New Employee Entry Request

Category: Onboarding & User Provisioning

Purpose

A request is raised to create a new employee account.

When to use this guide

New employee onboarding

Recommended procedure

1. Validate the approved request and required employee details.

2. Select the correct OU, create the account using the organization's naming convention, assign only role-appropriate groups, and record the account details in the approved register.

3. Coordinate initial credentials securely.

Verification

Verify the account appears in the intended OU, group memberships are correct, and the user can authenticate as expected. Record completion against the request.

HD-009 | Configuring New Team and Users

Category: Onboarding & User Provisioning

Purpose

A new team structure and associated user accounts need to be configured.

When to use this guide

Team and user setup

Recommended procedure

1. Confirm the team name, OU placement, users, naming conventions, and access requirements.
2. Create or verify the OU structure, create accounts, and use role-based security groups for shared access.
3. Avoid relying on individual permissions where group-based access is appropriate.

Verification

Check each account's OU and group membership. Test access with representative users and confirm separation between teams.

HD-017 Offboarding Employee Noah Wilson

Category: Onboarding & User Provisioning

Purpose

An employee in Sales is leaving and their directory access must be removed.

When to use this guide

Employee offboarding

Recommended procedure

1. Confirm the approved departure date and scope with the authorized requester.
2. Disable the account at the correct time, revoke or remove access according to policy, preserve data as instructed, and document ownership/transfer of business files.
3. Follow retention requirements before deleting anything.

Verification

Verify the account is disabled and access is no longer available. Record completion and any outstanding mailbox, file, or equipment actions.

HD-004 | Unauthorized Shared Folder Access

Category: Security & Access Control

Purpose

A user may have access to a folder that is outside their job responsibilities.

When to use this guide

Unauthorized access

Recommended procedure

1. Identify the exact folder and user.

2. Review share permissions, NTFS permissions, inherited entries, and security-group membership.

3. Confirm the intended access model with the data owner before changing permissions.

Verification

Test as the affected user and, where possible, an authorized user. Confirm the unauthorized path is denied while legitimate access remains functional. Preserve evidence of the before-and-after permission review.

HD-006 | Manager Access

Category: Delegation & Manager Access

Purpose

A manager access request requires the intended manager relationship or access to management resources.

When to use this guide

Manager permissions

Recommended procedure

1. Clarify whether the request concerns the AD Manager attribute, access to a management folder, or delegated administrative rights.

2. These are different controls. Confirm approval, identify the correct user object, and apply only the requested change.

Verification

Verify the manager attribute or resource access independently. Do not assume setting the Manager attribute grants folder permissions or administrative privileges.

HD-007 | Manager Folder Access Request

Category: Delegation & Manager Access

Purpose

A manager requests access to a management folder.

When to use this guide

Management folder access

Recommended procedure

1. Confirm the manager's identity, business justification, folder owner approval, and required access level.
2. Prefer assigning access through a dedicated security group rather than directly to an individual.
3. Review share and NTFS permissions before making changes.

Verification

Test with the manager's account and confirm other employees do not gain unintended access. Document the group and permission level granted.

HD-010 | Introducing Changed Account Lockout Policy

Category: Group Policy & Security

Purpose

The domain account lockout policy is being changed or introduced.

When to use this guide

Account lockout policy

Recommended procedure

1. Document the approved threshold, lockout duration, and reset-counter interval.
2. Identify where the policy is configured and its scope.
3. In a domain environment, verify the effective domain account policy rather than assuming a workstation-local setting controls domain accounts.

Verification

Use policy-result or domain-policy inspection tools to confirm the effective settings. Test cautiously with a lab account; avoid locking out administrator or production accounts.

HD-011 | Assigning Employee ID

Category: PowerShell & Directory Administration

Purpose

Employee identifiers are being assigned to directory users.

When to use this guide

Employee ID assignment

Recommended procedure

1. Confirm the required format (for example EMP001), uniqueness rules, and source of truth.

2. Check existing employeeID values before assigning a new value.

3. Record the assignment and avoid reusing identifiers from former employees unless policy explicitly permits it.

Verification

Query the directory to confirm the intended account has the expected employeeID and that no duplicate value was introduced.

HD-020 | Assign a Unique Employee ID to Jamie Taylor

Category: PowerShell & Directory Administration

Purpose

A unique employee identifier is requested for Jamie Taylor.

When to use this guide

Unique employee ID allocation

Recommended procedure

1. Find the exact user object using a reliable identifier such as sAMAccountName or distinguished name rather than assuming the display name is unique.

2. Query existing employeeID values, select an unused ID following the approved format, and update the correct object.

Verification

Read the employeeID back from the same user object and run a duplicate check. Record the assigned ID in the approved register without exposing unnecessary personal information.

HD-021 | Develop PowerShell Scripts for Active Directory

Category: PowerShell & Directory Administration

Purpose

PowerShell scripts are developed to support routine Active Directory administration.

When to use this guide

Directory automation

Recommended procedure

1. Maintain scripts for repeatable tasks such as user creation, account checks, group membership reporting, and employee-ID validation.

2. Use clear prompts, input validation, error handling, least-privilege execution, and safe defaults.

3. Test scripts against lab accounts before wider use.

Verification

Capture sample output and test cases, including invalid input and missing objects. Keep scripts versioned, document prerequisites, and never embed passwords or secrets.

HD-013 | Unidentified Login Attempts

Category: Security & Authentication

Purpose

Unrecognized or unexpected login attempts have been observed.

When to use this guide

Unrecognized authentication activity

Recommended procedure

1. Record the affected account, time window, source workstation if available, and relevant event details.

2. Review available Windows security logs and domain-controller authentication events.

3. Distinguish failed attempts from successful logons and escalate suspicious activity according to the incident process.

Verification

Confirm whether the activity is understood and whether containment or credential changes are required. Preserve logs and avoid asserting compromise without supporting evidence.

HD-016 | Backup Operator Unable to Perform File Backup

Category: Backup & Recovery

Purpose

A user assigned backup-related responsibilities cannot perform the expected file backup operation.

When to use this guide

Backup operation failure

Recommended procedure

1. Clarify the backup task, target, source data, and exact error.

2. Verify the account's group membership and the backup tool's required privileges.

3. The Backup Operators group does not automatically configure a backup job, destination, schedule, or credentials for every backup application.

Verification

Run a controlled test backup to an approved destination and verify the resulting backup. Document the tool, scope, job configuration, and restore-test evidence.

HD-018 | Dedicated Folder for Backup Operator Access

Category: Backup & Recovery

Purpose

A dedicated folder is requested for backup-related work.

When to use this guide

Backup operator working folder

Recommended procedure

1. Confirm the folder's purpose, data classification, authorized users, retention, and backup destination.

2. Create a dedicated security group if appropriate and assign least-privilege share and NTFS permissions.

3. Separate ordinary user data from backup storage where practical.

Verification

Test access with the intended operator and a non-authorized account. Confirm backup files can be written and read by the intended process and that recovery can be performed.

HD-019 | Software Installation for Marketing Team

Category: Software & Workstation Support

Purpose

A software application is requested for Marketing users.

When to use this guide

Application deployment

Recommended procedure

1. Confirm the software is approved, licensed, compatible, and obtained from a trusted source.

2. Determine whether it should be installed per-machine or per-user.

3. For multiple workstations, consider centralized deployment or endpoint-management tooling rather than manually installing on one shared computer.

Verification

Verify the application launches for the intended users and does not require unnecessary administrative privileges. Record version, installer source, target devices, and test result.

HD-022 | Configure File Version History (Shadow Copies)

Category: Backup & Recovery

Purpose

Document the configuration of Windows Server Shadow Copies to make earlier versions of shared files available for recovery after accidental edits.

When to use this guide

Use when a user needs to retrieve an earlier version of a file stored on the CompanyShare volume, or when an administrator needs to enable Previous Versions for a shared folder.

Recommended procedure

1. Sign in to DC01 with an authorized administrative account and identify the volume containing C:\CompanyShare.
2. Open the volume Properties > Shadow Copies tab, select the appropriate volume, and enable Shadow Copies.
3. Configure a storage limit suitable for the lab (5 GB was selected for this exercise) and create a manual snapshot.
4. In the Employees share, create or locate a non-sensitive test file (Employee-Policy-Test.txt). From CLIENT01, sign in as Jamie Taylor and edit the file from Version 1 to Version 2.
5. Open the file or parent folder Properties > Previous Versions and inspect the available snapshot. Prefer opening or copying a prior version before using Restore, which can overwrite the current version.

Verification

Confirm that a snapshot is listed with a timestamp and that an earlier file version is accessible. Record separately whether the file was only viewed, copied, or fully restored; do not report a successful restore without testing it.

HD-023 | Automated File Version History

Category: Backup & Recovery

Purpose

Maintain regularly scheduled Shadow Copies so earlier file versions can be recovered without relying solely on manually created snapshots.

When to use this guide

Use when administrators need predictable version-history checkpoints for the volume hosting CompanyShare.

Recommended procedure

1. On DC01, open the volume Properties > Shadow Copies tab and select the configured volume.
2. Open Settings > Schedule and review the existing snapshot schedule.
3. Configure the lab schedule for 9:00 AM and 3:00 PM daily, taking care not to create unintended duplicate schedules.
4. Confirm the 5 GB storage limit remains appropriate and save the configuration.
5. Review the schedule and the snapshot timestamps after the next scheduled run.

Verification

Confirm the schedule entries are saved. For full validation, verify that snapshots are actually created at distinct scheduled times without manual intervention. Schedule configuration alone does not prove unattended execution.

HD-024 | Centralized IT Announcement System

Category: IT Communications & Automation

Purpose

Publish IT notices centrally and display each new announcement once per signed-in domain user through a Windows pop-up on CLIENT01.

When to use this guide

Use when an authorized administrator needs to communicate a non-confidential IT notice to domain users at their next sign-in.

Recommended procedure

1. On DC01, maintain the shared directory C:\CompanyShare\IT-Announcements, accessible as \\DC01\CompanyShare\IT-Announcements. Grant ordinary authenticated users read access and restrict modification to administrators.

2. Update Current-Announcement.json with AnnouncementID, Title, Message, PublishedBy, and Version. Assign a new unique AnnouncementID for each new notice.

3. Keep Show-ITAnnouncement.ps1 in the shared location. The script reads the JSON, displays a Windows Forms dialog, and records IDs already shown to the user in %LOCALAPPDATA%\AKLabIT\SeenAnnouncements.txt.

4. Use the GPO AKLab-IT-Announcements-Policy to deploy the Group Policy Preferences scheduled task AKLAB-IT-Announcement. Configure it for the interactive signed-in user and a 30-second delay after logon (PT30S).

5. Sign in to CLIENT01 with test users such as Jamie Taylor and Olivia Martin. Confirm the notice appears once for a new ID and is not repeated for an ID already recorded.

6. To publish another notice, edit the JSON and use a fresh AnnouncementID. The next sign-in is the intended display trigger; this setup does not push the notice immediately to an existing session.

Troubleshooting

If the GPO applies but the task is not created or does not run, check the Group Policy Preferences Scheduled Tasks item, principal and run context, script share permissions, and Task Scheduler history. During testing, an Event ID 4098 failure with error 0x80070005 (Access is denied) occurred for Olivia. Review the task Common tab and whether it runs in the logged-on user security context. Confirm the script is readable by the user and that local seen-ID storage is writable.

Verification

Verify successful pop-up display for multiple domain users; verify one-time suppression per user; verify a new announcement ID triggers a new pop-up after sign-in. The lab testing was reported working after the scheduled-task access issue was corrected.
